

United States International Young Physicist Tournament

2027 Selection Process

All students should contact US IYPT either through instagram at @iypt_usa or through email at physics.iypt@gmail.com.

Once we know you are competing we can provide resources to help you be successful.

US IYPT will provide monthly opportunities for students and teachers to receive guidance on both the physics necessary for research and how to produce successful reports.

Students must have a local mentor to ensure their safety during experiments and to provide guidance on the physics.

Selection process details

- 1) Students should inform us of their intention to participate at physics.iypt@gmail.com.
- 2) Students are to supply a first draft of their research slides and a brief explanation video (< 10 minutes) for 1 problem to physics.iypt@gmail.com via email no later than midnight January 18th.
- 3) Our team of college professors will evaluate your submissions. Every submission will receive detailed feedback on both the strengths and areas for improvement of your submission.
- 4) The best reports will be selected as finalists for consideration on the National team that will travel to New Zealand for IYPT 2027. These finalists will be given concrete suggestions on how to improve their research to make their final submission tournament ready.
- 5) Students will submit their final reports and a 12 minute video presentation with suggested improvements by midnight on February 26th.

We have provided an example of slides and a video recording of the spaghetti accelerator problem from 2025.. This was our highest-scoring problem of that year's tournament.

[Spaghetti Accelerator Slides](#)

[Example Spaghetti Accelerator Video Submission](#)

- 6) The national select board is composed of college professors, former IYPT jurors, and former team leaders. This board will evaluate the final submissions and select the students that could represent team USA in New Zealand.

7) Students under consideration for the national team will be interviewed to discuss their problem with members of the selection board. Following these interviews the 5 team members will be chosen.

8) Team members will then need to complete an additional problem prior to the tournament in July. Information about the second problem will be provided during the selection interviews or upon request.

9) Applicants may work individually or as a team of students. However, only one student can submit the work for a problem. All applicants must work with a teaching professional to ensure their safety.

Selecting problems

Most important to us is that you have a good experience and selecting the right problem is step one. In an ideal world, every student would pick a problem they found exciting and our best students would all think different problems are the exciting ones. With this in mind we would like students to let us know which problem they have selected to complete so that we can direct future students to unique problems. We are not going to force you to choose a specific problem, but we will let you know if there are already many other students researching the same problem.

Student Support with research:

Every month we will arrange several 30 minute video conference calls with subject matter experts to help you with your work. When requested, we can facilitate finding academic research. We can provide guidance on experimental design and data analysis. These meetings will be by appointment and first come first served.

Cost of Participation:

We are currently aggressively fundraising for Team USA 2027. Worst case scenario is that we fundraise \$0 dollars and the estimated cost would be \$5000 per student. However, we expect that not to be the case. When you indicate an interest in participation we will keep you apprised of our fundraising efforts.

Estimated Travel

The tournament runs from July 5th to July 12th in Auckland New Zealand. We will arrive early to adjust to the time change and depart on the 12th. Exact dates are pending.

Travel Dates: Arrive in Philly June 30th for pre-tournament "bootcamp". Fly out together July 2nd to Auckland.

Tournament Dates: July 5th-July 12

Return to Philadelphia: July 12.